10th Class English • Unit 4 • Punjab Board (New Syllabus 2026)

The Earth: Act Now for Tomorrow

Fully solved exercises: comprehension, MCQs, glossary, euphemism and oxymoron, climate presentation and debate, story sequencing and creative writing

A. The Essay at a Glance

Type: a non-fiction, persuasive and expository essay. **Tone:** serious, urgent and hopeful at the end. **Organisation: problem → causes → effects → solutions → conclusion** (problem-solution pattern with cause-effect inside it).

Central idea: the Earth is in danger because of human-made climate change; climate action is not only a scientific necessity but a social, economic and moral duty of governments and of every individual, and it is still possible if we act now.

Part of the essay	What it says
Introduction	Earth is in danger: rising temperatures, melting ice caps, frequent disasters and shifting weather. **Climate action** = efforts of individuals, governments and organisations to reduce greenhouse gas emissions, adapt to change and protect the environment.
Causes	Burning fossil fuels (coal, oil, gas) releases CO_2; agriculture, deforestation and industry release methane and nitrous oxide. These gases trap heat — global warming.
Effects	Glaciers melt and sea levels rise; hurricanes, floods, heatwaves and wildfires become frequent; farmers face unpredictable rain and drought, so food production falls and hunger rises.
Injustice	Poor and developing countries suffer most although they pollute least, because they lack money and infrastructure to recover — a matter of justice and fairness.
Global action	The **Paris Agreement (2015)**: almost every country agreed to keep warming well below 2°C and to try for 1.5°C by cutting emissions, investing in renewable energy and improving energy efficiency.
Individual action	Save energy, recycle, avoid single-use plastic, use public transport, eat less meat, plant trees, support eco-friendly brands, spread awareness and hold companies accountable.
Hope and end	Emissions still rise and some industries resist, but solar, wind, electric vehicles and carbon capture are cheaper, and young people are leading. “Time is running out, but the opportunity to act is still in our hands.”

B. Questions Given Beside the Text

1. What is the main goal of the Paris Agreement?

The main goal of the Paris Agreement (2015) is to keep global warming “well below 2°C” above pre-industrial levels, with efforts to keep it below 1.5°C. To reach this goal, the countries promised to reduce carbon emissions, invest in renewable energy and improve energy efficiency.

2. How can individuals contribute to protecting the environment?

Individuals can reduce their energy use, recycle waste, avoid single-use plastic and use public transport instead of private cars. They can eat less meat, plant trees, support eco-friendly brands and bring their own water bottles and bags. Above all, they can learn about environmental issues, spread awareness in their community and hold companies accountable for the damage they do.

C. Reading Comprehension — Answer the following questions

1. What is climate action, according to the essay?

According to the essay, climate action means all the efforts taken by individuals, governments and organisations to (i) reduce greenhouse gas emissions, (ii) adapt to the changing climate, and (iii) protect our environment. It is not only an environmental issue; it is also a social, economic and moral responsibility that needs urgent and collective action.

2. Mention at least two human activities that contribute to climate change.

(i) Burning fossil fuels such as coal, oil and gas for energy, which releases carbon dioxide into the air. **(ii) Deforestation**, the cutting down of forests, which removes the trees that absorb CO_2. **(iii) Agriculture and industrial processes**, which release methane and nitrous oxide. All these gases trap heat in the atmosphere and cause global warming.

3. Name the two negative effects of climate change mentioned in the essay.

(i) Melting glaciers and rising sea levels, which threaten coastal communities. **(ii) Extreme weather events** — hurricanes, floods, heatwaves and wildfires — which are becoming more frequent and intense and which destroy lives and ecosystems. The essay also mentions unpredictable rainfall and droughts, which reduce food production and increase hunger.

4. What is the purpose of the Paris Agreement?

The Paris Agreement, signed in 2015, is an international agreement in which almost every country of the world promised to fight climate change together. Its purpose is to limit global warming to well below 2°C, with efforts to keep it below 1.5°C, by reducing carbon emissions, investing in renewable energy and improving energy efficiency.

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5. Give an example of how individuals can take part in climate action.

An individual can take part by using public transport instead of a private car, by recycling household waste and avoiding single-use plastic, by switching off unnecessary lights and fans to save energy, by planting and watering trees, and by spreading awareness in the family and the neighbourhood. Even one student can start a cleanliness and tree plantation drive in his school.

6. Why do you think that climate change is our moral responsibility?

Climate change is our moral responsibility for three reasons. First, we human beings caused it by our own choices, so we cannot blame nature for it. Second, its worst sufferers are the poor, the weak and the unborn — people who did not make this problem and cannot escape it. Third, we are only the caretakers of the Earth, not its owners; the Qur'an teaches that man is Allah's khalifah on earth, and the Rasoolullah (PBUH) forbade the wasting of water even at a flowing river. A duty towards the weak and the future is always a moral duty.

7. Why are the poor countries more vulnerable to the effects of climate change, even though they pollute less?

Poor and developing countries are more vulnerable because they contribute the least to the problem but have the fewest means to bear it. They often lack the money, technology and infrastructure to protect themselves from floods, heatwaves and droughts, and they cannot recover quickly after a disaster. Their economies depend on farming, which is the first thing climate change damages, and they have no insurance or savings to rebuild their homes. This is why the essay calls climate action “a matter of justice and fairness”.

D. Choose the Correct Option (MCQs) — solved with key

1. What is the main purpose of climate action?

- to reduce food waste
- to reduce greenhouse gas emissions and protect the environment
- to lower energy bills
- to improve international trade

Answer: to reduce greenhouse gas emissions and protect the environment — The essay defines climate action in exactly these words.

2. Which of the following is a major cause of climate change according to the essay?

- overpopulation
- human activities such as burning fossil fuels
- natural disasters
- use of solar panels

Answer: human activities such as burning fossil fuels — Coal, oil and gas release carbon dioxide and trap heat.

3. The Paris Agreement aims to:

- stop using all forms of energy
- limit global warming to below 2°C
- end trade between countries
- increase the production of oil and coal

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Answer: limit global warming to below 2°C — The target is well below 2°C, with efforts for 1.5°C.

4. What is a major consequence of rising global temperatures mentioned in the essay?

- increase in literacy rates
- fewer rainy days
- melting glaciers and rising sea levels
- more employment opportunities

Answer: melting glaciers and rising sea levels — The essay names glaciers melting at alarming rates as a visible effect.

5. Why are the poor and developing countries more affected by climate change?

- They pollute the most.
- They often lack resources to recover or adapt.
- They are more prepared for disasters.
- They benefit more from global warming.

Answer: They often lack resources to recover or adapt. — The essay says they lack the resources to recover or adapt.

6. Which of the following is an example of individual climate action?

- building highways
- buying more packaged food
- using public transport instead of personal vehicles
- travelling by airplane frequently

Answer: using public transport instead of personal vehicles — Public transport is named among everyday individual choices.

7. The phrase "a global conversation rather than a fringe concern" suggests that:

- climate change is only discussed in scientific circles.
- only young people are concerned about climate change.
- everyone around the world is now talking about climate change.
- climate action is not important anymore.

Answer: everyone around the world is now talking about climate change. — A "fringe concern" is a minor issue; the phrase says it is now global and mainstream.

E. Glossary — Words and Meanings

Word	Meaning
crucial	of great importance
disaster	an event that results in great harm, damage or death
disproportionately	in a way that is too large or too small in relation to something else
disrupt	to interrupt an event, activity or process by causing a disturbance

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Word	Meaning
emission	the production and discharge of gas or radiation
impact	a strong effect
innovation	a new method, idea or product
intense	of extreme force, degree or strength
opportunity	a good chance for advancement or progress
renewable	capable of being replaced (e.g. solar and wind energy)
sustainable	able to be maintained at a certain rate or level

F. Vocabulary and Grammar — Figures of Speech in Context

Figure of speech	Definition and example
Figures of speech (general)	Words or phrases used in a creative, non-literal way to make writing vivid, emotional or powerful.
Euphemism	A polite or mild way of saying something unpleasant — "passed away" instead of "died".
Oxymoron	Two opposite words put together for an interesting or meaningful effect — "deafening silence".

Understanding these in context helps the reader to find the writer's tone, attitude and meaning.

Questions on the paragraph "The climate crisis is a silent killer"

1. Identify the euphemism in this paragraph. What does it imply about how the topic is being framed?

The euphemism is the phrase "**climate action**" itself, which people use instead of the harsher reality of a "climate emergency" or a "climate crisis". The writer says that this soft phrase makes the issue "sound more manageable, as if there is a simple solution to a complex and urgent problem". So the framing is dangerous: polite words hide the emergency and make people relax when they should be alarmed.

2. What is the oxymoron used in this paragraph? How does it create a contrast or emphasise a point?

The oxymoron is "**deafening silence**". Silence is the absence of sound, yet it is called deafening, that is, louder than any noise. The contradiction gives force to the writer's attack: the inaction of those in power is so complete and so shocking that it is like a roar in our ears. The silent world leaders become louder than the scientists who are warning us.

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3. Why do you think the writer uses figures of speech like “silent killer” and “ticking time bomb”? How do these expressions affect the tone?

The writer uses them because abstract facts about emissions do not move the reader, while pictures do. “Silent killer” personifies climate change as a murderer who attacks without a warning, and “a ticking time bomb” shows that a fixed and short time is left before a disaster explodes. Both create **fear, urgency and tension**, so the tone becomes alarming and urgent instead of calm and informative, and the reader feels personally threatened rather than merely informed.

Responsibility”

What the model dialogue teaches: Ayaan begins with the reading he did and asks Zara's opinion; Zara answers with a reason (money and infrastructure); both take turns, ask follow-up questions, give their own examples (public transport, composting, water bottle) and end with a joint plan — starting a climate club in school. A good dialogue always ends in a decision or a promise, not in the air.

Model presentation — “Climate Talk: Speak Up for the Planet!”

Respected teacher and dear friends, Assalam-o-Alaikum. My topic is climate action, and my message is in one line: the planet does not need a few perfect people; it needs millions of ordinary people who stop making the problem worse.

Let me give you three numbers. First, our country is among the ten most affected countries of the world by climate change, although our share in global emissions is less than one per cent. Second, the floods of 2022 pushed more than thirty million people out of their homes and cost us billions of rupees. Third, one mature tree absorbs about twenty kilograms of carbon dioxide in a year, so a school that plants two hundred trees absorbs four tonnes every year.

These numbers give us three duties. As students, we must save electricity and water, refuse plastic bags and plant trees in our own streets. As a school, we can start a climate club that collects paper for recycling and holds a monthly awareness assembly. As citizens, we must hold our leaders and industries to their promises, because the Paris Agreement of 2015 means nothing if the targets are only on paper.

I end with a question for every one of you: if not us, and if not now, then who and when? Thank you.

Debate points — “What does climate change mean to you personally?”

For the motion: it means longer summers and shorter winters in my own city, more dust and less rain, and the fear that my village's crops will fail; it is personal because my family's food and my school holidays both depend on the weather. **Against the motion:** it is a global problem of industries and governments, and one student's plastic bag cannot change the temperature of the Earth, so time is better spent on studies than on guilt. **Balanced view:** it is global in size but personal in cause — every bag, every light left on and every tree planted is a vote for the future.

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H. Writing Skills — Techniques to Sequence Events

Technique	What the writer must do
i. Engage and orient the reader	Catch attention at once and give a clear sense of what is happening and where.
ii. Set out a problem, situation or observation	Introduce the central focus of the story early, in the first paragraph.
iii. Show its significance	Tell the reader why it matters — what will be lost or gained.
iv. Establish point of view	Decide who tells the story: first person (I), third person (he/she), or more than one viewpoint.
v. Introduce narrator and characters	Present the voice of the story and the people in it, with one clear detail each.
vi. Create a smooth progression	Arrange events logically, without confusing jumps, using time words (then, later, at last).

Task 1: the first paragraph of a story (situation + significance + character)

The last bell had rung, but Hina was still standing in the empty classroom, holding a torn page of the attendance register. Someone had written her name in the “absent” column of every day of the month, though she had not missed a single class. If the register went to the office like this, her scholarship would be cancelled and her father, a peon in the same school, would have to explain the shame. She looked at the handwriting again — neat, small, and terribly familiar.

Task 2: rewrite the flat opening “I woke up and got ready for school”

Flat: I woke up and got ready for school. **Rewritten:** The alarm screamed at half past five, but I was already awake — I had been awake all night, because today was the day I had to tell my teacher the truth about the broken window. I washed my face, buttoned my shirt twice before the buttons obeyed me, and stood at the door for a full minute before I could open it.

Task 3: a short scene with dialogue showing a character facing a challenge

The water was already at the third step of the shop when Bilal reached it. His father was inside, lifting sacks of flour on to the counter.

“Baba, leave the sacks!” Bilal shouted over the noise of the rain. “The wall is going to fall.”

“The sacks are the shop,” his father said, without turning. “If the flour goes, we go.”

Bilal stood for a second, then waded in. The cold water climbed to his waist. He took the corner of the nearest sack, and together, father and son, they carried it up the stairs, and then another, and another, while the wall behind them groaned and the

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rain hammered on the tin roof like a drum.
“Why did you come in?” his father asked at last, breathing hard.
“Because you would not come out,” Bilal said.

Task 4: a short story with a mystery (beginning, middle, ending)

A Letter with No Name

Beginning: The first letter came on a hot Friday afternoon, slipped under the door of Sana's house in Johar Town. There was no stamp, no return address, no name of the sender — only one line: “Ask your mother about the blue trunk.” Sana read it four times. There was no blue trunk in their house.

Middle: A second letter came a week later: “The trunk is not in your house.” Then a third, with a bus ticket to Lahore and a time. Every letter knew something about her family that she did not know herself, and every letter was written in the same small, careful handwriting. She told nobody, not even her mother, and on Saturday she boarded the bus with the letters folded inside her notebook.

Ending: The address was an old bookshop in Anarkali. Behind the counter sat a woman of her mother's age, who opened a blue trunk and took out a photograph: two young women in a college garden, one of them her mother, the other the woman herself. “We were best friends,” she said. “Then your grandmother separated us, and your mother was told never to speak to me again.” The letters had waited twenty years to be sent. Sana put the photograph in her pocket, and for the first time she understood why her mother had always kept one old college book on the highest shelf.

I. Summary of the Essay

The Earth is in danger. Rising temperatures, melting ice caps, frequent disasters and shifting weather all show that the planet is in trouble, and the main cause is human activity. Burning fossil fuels releases carbon dioxide, while agriculture, deforestation and industry release methane and nitrous oxide; these gases trap heat and cause global warming. The effects are already visible: glaciers melt and the seas rise, extreme weather destroys lives and ecosystems, and farmers face drought and hunger. Poor countries suffer most although they pollute least, because they lack the money and infrastructure to recover, so climate action is a matter of justice as well as science. The world has responded through the Paris Agreement of 2015, in which almost every country promised to keep warming below 2°C, and businesses, movements and individuals are also acting through clean technology, recycling, public transport and tree planting. Emissions are still rising and some industries resist, but solar and wind energy are cheaper than before and young people are leading the campaign. The essay ends with a warning and a hope: time is running out, but the opportunity to act is still in our hands, and the choices we make today will shape the world of tomorrow.

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Points to Remember

• Climate action = reducing greenhouse gas emissions, adapting to change and protecting the environment.

• Main greenhouse gases: carbon dioxide (fossil fuels), methane and nitrous oxide (agriculture, deforestation, industry).

• Effects: melting glaciers and rising sea levels; hurricanes, floods, heatwaves, wildfires; drought, less food, more hunger.

• Paris Agreement, 2015: keep warming well below 2°C, efforts for 1.5°C.

• Climate justice: poor countries pollute least but suffer most because they lack resources.

• Individual action: save energy, recycle, no single-use plastic, public transport, less meat, plant trees, spread awareness.

• Figures of speech: euphemism (passed away), oxymoron (deafening silence), personification (silent killer), metaphor (ticking time bomb).

• Story opening: engage the reader, set out the problem, show why it matters, fix the point of view, introduce characters, progress smoothly.

• Glossary: crucial, disaster, disproportionately, disrupt, emission, impact, innovation, intense, opportunity, renewable, sustainable.

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